QOLAB

Creative Collective

CLIENT ONBOARDING SOP

From First Contact to Signed Contract

Document Type	Version	Location
Internal SOP	1.0	Nigeria

DOCUMENT OVERVIEW

This document is the standard operating procedure for QOLAB's pre-delivery client journey — from first contact through to signed contract and kickoff handoff. Every collective member must follow this process without exception.

Consistency in how QOLAB receives, qualifies, and converts clients is what separates the collective from a group of freelancers. The client experience begins before any work is done.

THE 9 STAGES AT A GLANCE

Stage 1	Discovery — How the client finds QOLAB
Stage 2	Application Form — Qualification and filtering
Stage 3	Internal Review — Fit assessment and team assignment
Stage 4	Strategy Call Invite — Controlled, personalised entry
Stage 5	Strategy Call — Diagnose, reframe, and pre-sell
Stage 6	Proposal Creation — Build the tailored offer
Stage 7	Proposal Delivery — Controlled presentation
Stage 8	Follow-Up System — Convert without chasing
Stage 9	Contract + Kickoff — Lock commitment and launch

NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

- One point of contact at all times — clients never deal with multiple people unsupervised
- Application-first — QOLAB does not accept every enquiry
- Every interaction is strategic, never transactional
- Same steps, same quality, same tone for every client

STAGE 01 DISCOVERY

How the client finds QOLAB

GOAL

Move a prospect into QOLAB's controlled entry point — the application form. Every piece of content, every bio link, and every referral must funnel to one single place.

DISCOVERY CHANNELS

- Instagram — primary channel; case studies, before-and-after transformations, process content
- LinkedIn — for corporate clients, SMEs, and B2B referrals
- Website — portfolio, case study archive, and application CTA
- Referrals — from satisfied clients or collective members

CTA — USED EVERYWHERE

> *"Apply to Work With QOLAB" — this is the only entry point. No direct WhatsApp number on public-facing content. No casual DM onboarding. One door.*

POSITIONING NOTE

Application-first positioning is intentional. It signals that QOLAB selects its clients — not the other way around. This creates a premium filter before any conversation begins.

STAGE 02 APPLICATION FORM

Qualification and filtering

GOAL

Understand who the prospect is, qualify their budget and readiness, and establish QOLAB as a strategic partner from the very first touchpoint.

PLATFORM

Use Tally, Typeform, or a custom form on the QOLAB website. The form must be clean, branded, and mobile-optimised.

FORM STRUCTURE

Section A — Basic Information

- Full name
- Email address
- Business name
- Website or social media link (if any)

Section B — Business Snapshot

- What does your business do?
- Who do you serve?
- What stage is your business at? (Idea / Early / Growing / Established)

Section C — Needs Assessment

- What do you need help with? (Select all that apply)
  - Brand identity and design
  - Website design and development
  - Marketing strategy and content
  - Full brand build — all of the above

Section D — Problem Framing

- What is currently not working with your brand or marketing?
- What have you tried before, and why did it not work?

Section E — Vision

- Where do you want your brand to be in 6 to 12 months?

Section F — Budget Range ⚠ Non-negotiable field

- ₦500,000 – ₦1,500,000 ($300 – $1,000)
- ₦1,500,000 – ₦3,500,000 ($1,000 – $2,300)
- ₦3,500,000 and above ($2,300+)
- I am not sure yet

Why this field is non-negotiable

- It protects the collective's time immediately — no call is booked for clients who cannot afford the work
- Anyone who selects 'not sure' receives a soft follow-up email with budget context before a call is offered
- Anyone clearly below minimum budget gets a respectful decline — do not force the fit

Section G — Readiness and Timeline

- Are you ready to invest properly in building your brand? (Yes / Not yet)
- When are you looking to start? (Immediately / Within 1 month / Within 3 months / Just exploring)

AUTOMATED RESPONSE — SENT IMMEDIATELY ON SUBMISSION

Subject: We received your QOLAB application

Thank you for applying to work with QOLAB.

Your application has been received and will be reviewed by our lead strategist. If we believe there is a strong fit, you will receive a personalised invitation to a Strategy Session within 24 to 48 hours.

We look forward to the possibility of building something great together.

— The QOLAB Team

STAGE 03 INTERNAL REVIEW

Fit assessment and team assignment

GOAL

Before any call is booked, the lead strategist reviews every application and makes a deliberate decision. This is where QOLAB's selectivity is operationalised — not performed.

WHO REVIEWS

The lead strategist reviews all applications. No application proceeds to a call without explicit sign-off from the lead.

REVIEW CRITERIA

Budget fit	Does the stated budget align with QOLAB's minimum scope for the work requested?
Business readiness	Is the business at a stage where a brand build will actually move the needle?
Problem clarity	Does the applicant understand their problem, or will significant education be required?
Commitment signal	Did they answer Yes to readiness? Did they provide substantive, considered answers?
Timeline	Is their start date realistic given the collective's current capacity?

DECISION OUTCOMES

- Strong fit — invite to Strategy Call within 24 hours
- Potential fit — send a follow-up email to gather more context before deciding
- Not a fit — send a respectful decline email with a brief reason and, where possible, a referral

TEAM ASSIGNMENT — DONE BEFORE THE CALL

Once a prospect is confirmed as a strong fit, the lead strategist assigns the internal team immediately — before the Strategy Call, not after it.

- Assign: Lead Strategist — handles the call and owns the client relationship throughout
- Assign: Supporting specialists — designer, developer, marketer — based on the applicant's stated scope

Why assign before the call?

- You can present a named team confidently during the session
- It eliminates scrambling after the client says yes
- It signals operational maturity — QOLAB is already thinking about their brand before they pay

STAGE 04 STRATEGY CALL INVITE

Controlled, personalised entry

GOAL

The invitation must feel curated, not automated. The prospect should feel selected — because they were. This sets the tone for how QOLAB conducts itself throughout the relationship.

INVITE EMAIL TEMPLATE

Subject: You have been invited to a QOLAB Strategy Session

Hi [Name],

Thank you for your application. Having reviewed your submission carefully, we believe there is a strong opportunity here and would like to invite you to a Strategy Session with our lead strategist.

This is not a general discovery call. It is a focused 45-minute session in which we will map your current brand situation, identify the gaps, and outline what a build with QOLAB would look like for your business specifically.

Please book a time that works for you:

[Calendly or booking link]

Come prepared to talk about your business and your ambitions. We will handle the rest.

— [Lead Strategist Name], QOLAB

BOOKING LOGISTICS

- Use Calendly or Google Calendar booking link
- Limit available slots to a maximum of three per week — scarcity is intentional, not artificial
- Set a 15-minute buffer after each call in the calendar
- Send a confirmation email with a calendar invite and a one-line reminder of what to prepare

STAGE 05 STRATEGY CALL

Diagnose, reframe, and pre-sell

GOAL

Use this 45 to 60 minute session to deeply understand the client's situation, reframe how they see their problem, and create genuine desire for QOLAB's solution — all before any price is mentioned.

CALL STRUCTURE

Part 1 — Context (5–10 mins)

- Set the tone immediately: 'This session is about understanding your brand — not selling you something'
- Confirm key details from their application to demonstrate you actually read it
- Ask: 'Has anything changed, or is there anything you'd like to add before we begin?'

Part 2 — Deep Dive (15–20 mins)

- What does your current brand look, feel, and sound like?
- Where is it falling short — with customers, online, internally?
- What have you tried before? Why do you think it did not work?
- What does success look like for you in the next 12 months?

Part 3 — The Reframe (10 mins)

> *"What you're describing isn't a logo problem. It's a brand system problem. The visuals, the messaging, and the customer experience aren't working together. That is what we build."*

This is the most important moment in the call. Position their problem at a systems level, not a task level. This justifies the QOLAB model, the team approach, and the investment required.

Part 4 — Introduce QOLAB (5–10 mins)

- Explain the collective model: 'We do not assign you one person. We build you a team around your brand.'
- Name the roles relevant to their scope: strategist, designer, developer, marketer
- Emphasise: one point of contact, one structured process, one outcome

Part 5 — Solution Direction (5 mins)

- Give a high-level outline of how QOLAB would approach their specific situation
- Do not go into full scope detail — leave that for the proposal
- Use language like: 'Based on what you have shared, here is how we would approach this...'

Part 6 — Soft Close (5 mins)

> *"If we were to move forward, here is what the next step looks like. We will put together a tailored Brand Build Plan — not a generic quote — and walk you through it personally. Does that work for you?"*

What NOT to do on this call

- Do not give a price on the call unless directly and repeatedly pushed — let the proposal carry that weight
- Do not over-promise on scope — be directional, not definitive
- Do not let the call run past 60 minutes — this signals poor structure
- Do not allow the client to dominate with tangents — guide them firmly and with warmth

STAGE 06 PROPOSAL CREATION

Build the tailored offer

GOAL

Convert what was heard on the Strategy Call into a structured, professionally designed offer document. This is not a quote. It is called a Brand Build Plan.

TURNAROUND TIME

Deliver the proposal within 48 hours of the Strategy Call. Speed here signals competence. Delay signals disorganisation.

PROPOSAL STRUCTURE

1. Their Problem	Mirror back what they shared on the call — this shows you listened and builds deep trust
2. The Gap	What is missing, broken, or misaligned in their current brand and why it matters
3. Our Approach	How QOLAB will solve it — lead with strategy, follow with execution
4. Scope of Work	Clearly itemised deliverables — branding, website, marketing, as applicable to their need
5. The Team	Name the collective members assigned and their specific roles on this project
6. Timeline	Realistic phased delivery schedule with milestones
7. Investment	Tiered pricing where possible: Good / Better / Best
8. Next Step	One clear CTA — accept, request a walkthrough call, or ask questions

PRICING REFERENCE — NIGERIA

Starter Brand Build	₦500,000 – ₦1,500,000 | $300 – $1,000 | Logo, brand guide, social media kit
Full Brand Build	₦1,500,000 – ₦3,500,000 | $1,000 – $2,300 | Full brand identity + website
Complete Brand System	₦3,500,000+ | $2,300+ | Brand identity + website + marketing setup

PRESENTATION STANDARDS

- The proposal must be a designed PDF — not a Word document or a plain email breakdown
- Use QOLAB brand colours, consistent typography, and page numbers
- Include the client's name and business name on the cover page
- Maximum 12 pages — concise and visual, not exhaustive

STAGE 07 PROPOSAL DELIVERY

Controlled presentation

GOAL

Control how the client receives and processes the proposal. A well-delivered proposal converts better than a well-written one sitting unread in an inbox.

DEFAULT DELIVERY METHOD

Record a Loom video of 8 to 12 minutes walking through the proposal page by page, then send both the video link and the PDF in one email. The video humanises the document and dramatically increases engagement.

DELIVERY EMAIL TEMPLATE

Subject: Your QOLAB Brand Build Plan — [Business Name]

Hi [Name],

Thank you for your time on our Strategy Session. As promised, I have put together your personalised Brand Build Plan.

I have recorded a short walkthrough so you can hear the thinking behind each recommendation. Please watch the video before reviewing the PDF — it will make everything much clearer.

Video walkthrough: [Loom link]

Full proposal: [PDF attached or linked]

This proposal is valid for 7 days. If you have questions after reviewing, simply reply here or book a short follow-up call: [link]

Looking forward to building with you.

— [Name], QOLAB

PREMIUM OPTION

For prospects above ₦3,500,000 or $2,300, offer a live proposal walkthrough call in place of Loom. This signals the level of attention they will receive throughout the engagement.

PROPOSAL EXPIRY

- All proposals expire in 7 days from delivery — state this in the email and on the proposal document
- Expiry is not a pressure tactic — it is a boundary that protects collective capacity
- Extensions can be granted on request, but are not offered automatically

STAGE 08 FOLLOW-UP SYSTEM

Convert without chasing

GOAL

Follow up with purpose, not desperation. Every touchpoint after proposal delivery must add value or reduce friction. Never send a message that says only 'just checking in'.

FOLLOW-UP TIMELINE

Day 0	Proposal delivered via Loom walkthrough and PDF email
Day 2	Check-in: 'Have you had a chance to watch the walkthrough? Happy to answer any questions.'
Day 4	Value add: share a relevant case study, or address a specific objection you anticipate from this client
Day 6	Gentle urgency: 'Your proposal expires tomorrow. Want me to extend the window, or shall we book a quick call to close any open questions?'
Day 7	Final close: 'The proposal window closes today. If the timing is not right, I completely understand — just let me know and I will close this for now.'

AFTER DAY 7

If there is no response, send one final message seven days later to leave the door open — then close the file and move on.

> *"No pressure at all. If your situation changes and QOLAB feels like the right fit in the future, we would genuinely love to hear from you. Wishing you the best with the build."*

Follow-up rules

- Never send more than one message per day
- Never apologise for following up — you are running a business
- Never offer a discount to push a close — it devalues the work and signals desperation
- Never continue chasing beyond Day 7 plus one final message

STAGE 09 CONTRACT + KICKOFF

Lock commitment and launch

GOAL

Once the client says yes, move quickly and professionally. The window between verbal agreement and contract signature is where hesitation grows. Close it fast.

ON VERBAL AGREEMENT — DO THIS IMMEDIATELY

1. Send the contract within 2 hours — use DocuSign, PandaDoc, or a PDF with e-signature
2. Send the deposit invoice at the same time — do not wait for the contract to be signed first
3. Send a WhatsApp or email confirmation: 'Sent both across now — please check your inbox.'

PAYMENT TERMS

Deposit	50% upfront — non-negotiable. Work does not begin without cleared payment.
Balance	50% on agreed delivery milestone or at project completion — define this in the contract
Currency	Agree Naira (₦) or USD ($) before contract is sent. State currency clearly in all documents.
Payment Methods	Bank transfer, Flutterwave, Paystack, or Wise (for USD clients)

KICKOFF WELCOME — SENT WITHIN 24 HOURS OF DEPOSIT CLEARING

Once payment clears, send a Kickoff Welcome message. Brief but significant — it eliminates the uncertainty clients feel after paying and sets the professional tone for everything that follows.

Subject: Welcome to QOLAB — Let's Build

Hi [Name],

Payment confirmed. We are officially on.

Here is what happens next:

1. Your dedicated point of contact throughout this project is [Name]

2. You will receive a short onboarding questionnaire within 24 hours to gather assets and any access we need

3. Your project kickoff call is booked for [Date and Time]

We are genuinely excited about this one. Let's build something great.

— [Name], QOLAB

KICKOFF CALL AGENDA (30 MINS)

- Introduce the assigned team by name and role
- Confirm scope, timeline, and key milestones — no surprises
- Collect outstanding assets: existing logos, brand files, platform access
- Set communication expectations: response times, preferred channels, review cycles
- Answer any final questions before delivery begins

Why the Kickoff matters

- It eliminates the anxiety clients feel in the gap between paying and receiving
- It sets expectations clearly before work begins — reducing revision requests later
- It makes the client feel like they hired a proper agency — because they did

NON-NEGOTIABLE STRUCTURE RULES

These are not suggestions. These are the structural decisions that determine whether QOLAB operates as a premium agency or collapses under its own model.

Rule 1 — One Point of Contact

The client interacts with one person throughout the pre-delivery phase: the lead strategist. Specialists are assigned and briefed internally. They do not communicate with the client unless explicitly managed and introduced by the lead.

Rule 2 — Commission Structure Agreed Before Any Assignment

Every collective member must have a signed commission agreement before being assigned to a client. No handshake deals. No assumptions.

Recommended split	70% to the delivering specialist / 30% retained by QOLAB — adjust as agreed collectively
Payment trigger	Specialist is paid only after the client's payment has cleared
Disputes	All disputes go through the lead strategist — never directly between specialist and client

Rule 3 — No Unmanaged Communication

Specialists do not DM clients, share personal contact details, or discuss pricing or scope independently. All client communication is routed through the lead until formally handed over during the delivery phase.

Rule 4 — Standardise the Experience

Use the same form, the same email templates, the same call structure, and the same proposal format for every single client. Consistency is the product. A bespoke process for each client is not premium — it is chaos.

Rule 5 — Deposit Before Work. Always.

No exceptions. Not for friends, not for referrals, not for 'quick jobs', not for people who 'just need one thing'. A 50% deposit is the floor. This is how a collective protects its members.

QOLAB is not a service. It is a curated team built around your brand.

— Internal SOP v1.0 | Lagos, Nigeria